

Paul Abrams

Senior Backend Engineer

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July 23, 2026

Dear LotusFlare Hiring Team,

I'm writing to apply for the **Senior Backend Engineer** role. What draws me to LotusFlare is the shape of the problem: mission-critical, highly available distributed systems handling millions of concurrent API calls, owned end-to-end by the engineers who build them. That describes the systems I've spent 15+ years building and operating — and the way I like to work.

The “ownership” expectation is where I'd start. My current independent project, **TWNR** (twnr.paulabrams.ca), is a public multiplayer game I architected, shipped, and operate on production **solo** — a Dockerized **Node.js + WebSocket** backend on **PostgreSQL**, with **JWT auth**, a **JSON-Schema-generated REST API contract** that doubles as live documentation, and **concurrency-correct game state** via transactional locking (`SELECT ... FOR UPDATE`). Before that, I spent nearly four years enhancing and **production-supporting a cloud-native microservices platform** at Employment and Social Development Canada — REST APIs between services, governed through an **API gateway (Azure API Management)**, with **queue-driven asynchronous fan-out** for bulk workloads. Earlier, at the Department of Justice, I was a core developer on a **load-balanced, geographically distributed** platform serving **5,000+ concurrent users nationally, 24/7**, where I rebuilt a high-traffic reporting path for a **50x speedup** and built a self-initiated **availability-monitoring suite** across the distributed tiers.

Against your requirements, briefly:

- **5-7+ years of scalable, secure production web services** — 15+, across national-scale government platforms and self-operated products.
- **Language-agnostic approach** — production **Node.js** (Express, NestJS) and **.NET / C#**, plus **Java** and **Python**. I haven't shipped Lua or Scala, but I grade code across ten-plus languages for LLM-evaluation contracts; new languages on a strong distributed-systems foundation come fast.
- **REST APIs, gateways, documentation, security** — API design between microservices, APIM gateway policies, self-documenting JSON-Schema contracts, **OAuth 2.0 / OIDC / PKCE / JWT**.
- **Concurrency and fault tolerance in high-traffic environments** — transactional locking, async queue-based fan-out, load-balanced multi-tier deployments, availability monitoring.
- **Security best practices** — DevSecOps by default: **SonarQube** and **OWASP ZAP** in pipelines, CWE/CVSS-graded audits, Managed Identities, TLS/certificate management, NIST-based controls.
- **SQL and NoSQL data modeling** — deep SQL Server / Azure SQL / PostgreSQL (schema design, indexing, partitioning, execution-plan tuning), working MongoDB.
- **Cloud, containers, serverless** — **Docker, Kubernetes/AKS, OpenShift**, Azure Functions, Terraform, CI/CD across Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, and Jenkins; Azure, AWS, and GCP exposure.

Your day-to-day — standups, the full develop/test/review/production cycle, close collaboration with product — matches how I've worked for years, including as a certified Scrum Master. I'm a Canadian citizen based in Toronto, comfortable working across time zones with a global team, and available on short notice. My CV is attached — I'd welcome the chance to talk.

Best regards,
Paul Abrams